

KOHO Guidebook for Canadians

Your complete guide to Canada's smartest money app



Affiliate-Created Guidebook — This guide was created by **MarieLandrySpyShop.com** (Marie-Soleil Seshat Landry) to help Canadians get the most out of KOHO. Some links in this guide are affiliate links — if you click and sign up, we may earn a small commission at no extra cost to you. **Thank you for supporting our work!**

KOHO has grown from a simple prepaid card into one of Canada's most popular financial apps, now serving over **1 million users**.^[reference:0] Whether you want to earn cash back, save with competitive interest, build your credit, or even trade crypto, KOHO puts it all in one place.

Ready to get started? [Claim your account today](#) and unlock a **\$40 welcome bonus** when you make your first purchase of \$20 or more within 30 days.^[reference:1]



Get Started with KOHO

Use this link to claim your \$40 bonus

What Is KOHO?

KOHO is a Canadian fintech company founded in 2017 that offers a reloadable prepaid Mastercard or Visa paired with a spending account, savings tools, and more.^[reference:2] Because it's a prepaid product rather than a credit card, **there's no credit check required** to sign up, and you can only spend what you've loaded — eliminating the risk of overspending or accumulating debt.^[reference:3]

Your funds are held in trust at **Peoples Trust Company**, a CDIC-member institution, so your balance is insured up to **\$100,000**.^[reference:4]



[Join KOHO now](#) and start earning cash back on every purchase.

KOHO Plans Compared

KOHO offers three account tiers. All plans come with a **free 30-day trial**, and you can switch anytime.[reference:5][reference:6]

Essential

\$0 /mo*

- 1% cash back on groceries, transport, food/drink[reference:7]
- 2% interest on your entire balance[reference:8]
- Free real-time e-Transfers[reference:9]
- Savings Goals + RoundUps[reference:10]
- 1 free credit score check / month[reference:11]

*Free when you set up direct deposit or deposit \$1,000/month.[reference:12]

Extra

\$12 /mo

- 1.5% cash back on groceries, transport, food/drink[reference:13]
- 0.25% cash back on all other purchases[reference:14]
- 2.5% interest on your entire balance[reference:15]
- No foreign transaction fees[reference:16]
- Free international ATM withdrawals[reference:17]
- 30% off Credit Building[reference:18]

Everything

\$14.75 /mo

- 2% cash back on groceries, transport, food/drink[reference:19]
- 0.5% cash back on everything else[reference:20]

- **3.5%** interest on your entire balance[reference:21]
- No foreign transaction fees[reference:22]
- Free international ATM withdrawals[reference:23]
- 50% off Credit Building[reference:24]
- Metal card + priority support[reference:25][reference:26]

Which plan is right for you? If your monthly spending on groceries, transportation, and dining is high enough, the extra cash back on Extra or Everything can offset — or even exceed — the monthly fee.[reference:27] [Sign up and try the free 30-day trial](#) to see which plan fits your lifestyle.

Key Features



Cash Back Rewards

KOHO rewards you for everyday spending. Earn cash back on groceries, transportation, and food & drink — plus bonus rates at partner merchants through in-app deals.[reference:28] Cash back is extra money from KOHO, not taken from your balance.[reference:29]

- **Essential:** 1% on groceries, transport, food/drink[reference:30]
- **Extra:** 1.5% on those categories + 0.25% on everything else[reference:31]
- **Everything:** 2% on those categories + 0.5% on everything else[reference:32]
- Up to **6.5% extra cash back** at select merchants[reference:33]



High-Interest Savings

Your KOHO balance earns interest automatically (once you opt in). Interest is calculated daily and paid monthly.[reference:34]

- **Non-Member:** 0.5%[reference:35]
- **Essential:** 2%[reference:36]
- **Extra:** 2.5%[reference:37]

- **Everything:** up to 3.5%[reference:38]

RoundUps & Savings Goals

RoundUps automatically save your spare change. When you make a purchase, KOHO rounds up the total to the nearest \$1, \$2, \$5, or \$10 (you choose) and moves the difference into your Savings balance.[reference:39]

Your **Goals and RoundUps** now function as a dedicated **Savings** balance, separate from your Spendable balance — so your savings stay protected from everyday spending.[reference:40]

👉 [Start saving automatically with KOHO](#)

Credit Building

KOHO's Secured Credit Building lets you build your credit history using your own money. It works like a savings account that helps boost your credit, and reports to **Equifax**. [reference:41][reference:42] The add-on is \$10/month, but Extra and Everything plans get 30% and 50% off respectively.[reference:43]

Travel Perks

- **No foreign transaction fees** on Extra and Everything plans[reference:44]
- **Free international ATM withdrawals** (1/month on Extra and Everything) [reference:45]
- Access to international eSIM store (Extra & Everything)[reference:46]
- Travel insurance included[reference:47]

Crypto Trading

As of 2026, KOHO offers in-app cryptocurrency trading via a partnership with **Ndax**. [reference:48] Trading fees range from 1.5% (Non-Member) down to 0.5% (Everything).[reference:49]

App & Other Tools

- **Free real-time Interac e-Transfers** — send and receive money instantly[reference:50]
- **Spending Insights** — track where your money goes[reference:51]
- **Virtual Card Library** — generate disposable digital cards for online shopping[reference:52]
- **Bill Pay** — pay utilities, credit cards, and subscriptions directly from your KOHO account[reference:53]
- **Joint Accounts** — manage money together with a partner[reference:54]
- **Cover (overdraft protection)** — borrow up to \$250[reference:55]

Feature Comparison at a Glance

Feature	Essential	Extra	Everything
Monthly fee	\$0*	\$12	\$14.75
Cash back (groceries, transport, food/drink)	1%	1.5%	2%
Cash back (everything else)	0%	0.25%	0.5%
Interest on balance	2%	2.5%	3.5%
Foreign transaction fees	—	✓ Waived	✓ Waived
International ATM fees	—	1st free/month	1st free/month
Credit Building discount	—	30% off	50% off
Free credit score	✓ 1/mo	✓ 1/mo	✓ 1/mo
Free real-time e-Transfers	✓	✓	✓
Savings Goals + RoundUps	✓	✓	✓
Virtual Card Library	✓	✓	✓
Metal card	—	—	✓

*Essential is free when you set up direct deposit or deposit \$1,000/month.[reference:56] All plans include a 30-day free trial.[reference:57]

How to Get Started with KOHO

1. **Sign up** — Click [this exclusive link](#) to create your account. **Use code GETCASH** to claim your \$40 welcome bonus after your first purchase of \$20 or more within 30 days.[reference:58]
2. **Load money** — Add funds via Interac e-Transfer, direct deposit, or bill pay from your bank.[reference:59]
3. **Choose your plan** — Start with the free 30-day trial of any plan and see which one fits your spending habits.[reference:60]
4. **Start spending & saving** — Use your virtual or physical card anywhere Mastercard is accepted. Turn on RoundUps to save automatically.[reference:61]



Sign Up & Claim Your \$40 Bonus

Use this affiliate link — thank you for supporting MarieLandrySpyShop.com

Pro Tips for KOHO Users

- **Get Essential for free** — Set up a recurring direct deposit (payroll or government payment) or deposit at least \$1,000 total each month. Your eligibility is assessed monthly.[reference:62]
- **Maximize cash back** — Use your KOHO card for groceries, transportation, and dining to earn the highest cash back rates. Check the in-app partner deals for up to 6.5% extra cash back at select merchants.[reference:63]
- **Save without thinking** — Turn on RoundUps and choose a round-up amount (\$1, \$2, \$5, or \$10). Every purchase automatically tucks away spare change into your Savings balance.[reference:64]
- **Protect your savings** — Remember that your Savings balance (Goals + RoundUps) is separate from Spendable. If you need to use saved money, cash it out to Spendable first — it's instant.[reference:65]
- **Build credit affordably** — If you're on Extra or Everything, take advantage of the

discount on Credit Building to boost your credit score for less.[reference:66]

- **Travel smart** — Use Extra or Everything plans to avoid foreign transaction fees and get one free international ATM withdrawal per month.[reference:67]

Frequently Asked Questions

Is there a credit check to sign up?

No — KOHO is a prepaid product, so there's no credit check required.[reference:68]

Is my money safe?

Yes. Your funds are held in trust at Peoples Trust Company, a CDIC-member institution, and are insured up to \$100,000.[reference:69]

Can I use KOHO internationally?

Absolutely. KOHO works anywhere Mastercard is accepted. Extra and Everything plans waive foreign transaction fees and include free international ATM withdrawals.[reference:70][reference:71]

How do I load money onto my KOHO account?

You can load funds via Interac e-Transfer, direct deposit, or bill pay from your external bank account.[reference:72]

What happens if I don't qualify for free Essential?

If you don't meet the direct deposit or \$1,000/month deposit requirement, you'll be charged the regular Essential fee for that month. You can also upgrade to Extra or Everything anytime.[reference:73]

Can I cancel or change my plan?

Yes — go to My Plan in the app, scroll down, and select Manage my plan. You can cancel or downgrade at any time. Benefits continue until the end of your billing cycle.[reference:74]

Ready to take control of your money?

Join over 1 million Canadians who use KOHO to earn cash back, save smarter, and build their financial future.

 Get Your \$40 Welcome Bonus

Exclusive affiliate link — thank you for choosing MarieLandrySpyShop.com

*Bonus: \$40 after first purchase of \$20+ within 30 days. Terms apply.

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All information is based on publicly available sources and is believed to be accurate as of **August 2026**. Plans, rates, and features are subject to change. Always check the official KOHO app or website for the most current details.

 <https://referral.koho.ca/mzM6sF1>